S.V. Nallaperumal Pillai, missing for at least two years, suddenly made his appearance in May 1909 with the secret police noting that he had advanced some money, though how much and other details are unavailable.[32]

There were others too who cast their lot with the company trying to shore it up. There is a report that one Srinivasa Naicker, from VOC's village of Ottapidaram, had promised to invest Rs 1 lakh.[33] Idealists were also not found wanting: one E. Suryanarayanaiyar of Thanjavur gave up his legal practice to become SSNCo's local agent though he did not succeed in selling shares.[34]

Sadagopa Aiyangar, who lived across the street from VOC,[35] had been an employee of the port office before joining SSNCo in 1908. Described as 'a travelling agent' of SSNCo he was 'trying to dispose of the shares'.[36] Police suspected him of sending seditious pamphlets to K.R. Rangaswami Aiyangar 'of barber fame'![37] (In March 1908, a Swadeshi barber left K.R. Rangaswami Aiyangar, BI's lawyer, half shaved when the latter abused the Swadeshis. With no other barber willing to serve him, he was forced to go to Madurai by train, with police protection, to have the job completed. Rangaswami Aiyangar also appeared as a prosecution witness in VOC's sedition case.) Sadagopa Aiyangar's Swadeshi commitment is further attested to by the fact that, in April 1909—more than a year after VOC had been arrested—he was still canvassing shares. After travelling to Cuddalore to raise funds, he also visited Pondicherry frequently to meet the poet-in-exile Subramania Bharati who was said to be his intimate friend.[38] A month later, in May 1909, he claimed to have raised Rs 1 lakh in Thanjavur and Rs 10,000 in Cuddalore with local pleaders and merchants. From Pondicherry he also planned to visit Panruti and Chidambaram.[39] Evidently, the sedition cases had not frightened him, and he continued to work for the company.

K.R. Appadurai Iyer, the brother-in-law of Subramania Bharati (his wife Chellamma's elder brother), did similar work in the Telugu districts.[40] He was also in Varanasi and Calcutta, in August–September or thereabouts, as an employee of SSNCo.[41] Arriving in Rangoon on 1 November, he left for